

Figure 1: Open an existing VM



Figure 2: TKL first boot

For this demo, I've used VMware Workstation as my preferred virtualisation software. You could also use the latest version of VirtualBox, and its appliance import wizard, on the virtual machine image file.

After extracting, fire up VMware Workstation, and choose to open an existing VM (see Figure 1). This will load the virtual appliance settings from the *vmx* file. Power on the virtual machine and TKL will start loading. On the first boot, TKL auto-updates itself with the latest security updates, and so requires an Internet connection. If there is no Internet connection at the time, you can update it later by running the *cron-apt* command (see Figure 2).

Next, the TKL configuration console will be loaded, so ask for Ethernet settings. You can choose to automatically assign IP settings from DHCP, or provide a static IP manually. After this, you will see the usage screen as in Figure 3. TKL is pre-configured with a self-signed SSL certificate to enable access to configuration pages over HTTPS.

Don't forget to look at the *Advanced Menu* page. Select Quit, and you'll be presented with the TKL console log-in prompt. There is no password configured for the root user, by default. If you're going to be using this for serious work, don't forget to change the password. You can once again access the configuration console from the command-line by running *confconsole*.

As you can see on the usage screen, TKL comes preloaded with a file manager (it requires a Java-enabled Web

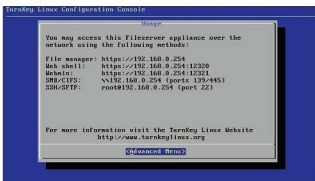


Figure 3: Usage screen

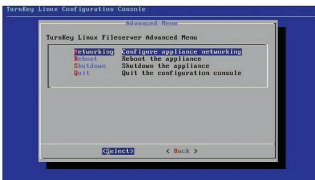


Figure 4: Advanced menu

browser), a Web-shell (an AJAX-based shell, no SSH client required), everyone's favourite Webmin Web-based systems management interface, and also with SSL, SMB/CIFS sharing, and SSH/SFTP access.

Known issues with TKL

1. TKL is configured to auto-update the latest security updates only. Non-security package updates won't be installed automatically—this can shatter the existing functionality of an appliance.
2. To upgrade to a newer version of an open source software package, you're advised to take a back-up of your existing appliance using a TurnKey Linux back-up and migration appliance (which will be covered in another article), and migrate to the new version of the appliance.
3. TKL has all the necessary packages, but if you still want to install packages of your choice, you must have an Internet connection and access to *apt*'s online package repository. You can use the command line, Webmin or the AJAX shell for package installation.

For more FAQs and open source software appliance-specific documentation, visit www.turnkeylinux.org. 

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